

Transit Short-Cuts: A Practical Tool for Vedic Astrologers

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*One of India's foremost astrologers shares his insights and experience
regarding major planetary transits.*

Every Vedic astrologer uses planetary transits as a short-cut technique for making predictions. Detailed examination of transit results involves elaborate analysis requiring a great deal of time. The short-cut approach however, quickly provides the essentials needed for the task at hand. Once this method is mastered and practical experience gained, this technique proves very rewarding.

The results of transiting planets are primarily examined in relationship to the natal Moon, although these relationships are also valid with regard to the Ascendant. Transits are very effective in producing their impact. Unless an individual is highly evolved and extraordinary stellar combinations are present in the horoscope, the transits of planets in relation to the natal Moon produces remarkable results. These results take place within the general framework of the *dasa/bhukti* positions at the time of counselling, and within the limitations imposed by the natal planetary positions. Ideally, one also takes into account *ashtakavarga* (specially calculated planetary strengths in relation to specific houses) and *vedhas* (obstructions blocking effects of transits).

For the most important predictive results, the transit effects of five planets (namely Saturn, Rahu, Jupiter, Mars and the Sun) are considered.

Transits of Saturn

Saturn's sidereal period is 29.46 years which gives it about 2 1/2 years in each sign. Its most inauspicious effects are experienced when it transits the 1st, 2nd and 12th houses from the Moon. This period of approximately 7 1/2 years is known as Saturn's *Sade Sati*, which in India is much dreaded because of the intense pain which may be experienced. There may occur death of near relations, frustration in one's undertakings, deterioration in social status, loss of income, increase in expenditure, and disturbing psychological isolation. This period repeats every 30 years or so. The first cycle is often intensely painful, the second leads to fruitless travels, and the third has the potential of killing one of the parents. During *Sade Sati*, Saturn may remove one of the major supports of the individual.

Saturn produces auspicious results during its sojourn in the 3rd, 6th and 11th houses from the Moon sign. During this period, the individual receives material gifts, increased income, and there is a rise in social status. The pattern of the individual's lifestyle changes for the better, impediments against his/her creativity are removed, long delayed rewards come through, and there is material affluence all through. Other results of this transit are recovery of debts, opening of fresh sources of income, emergence of new alignments in one's life, and greater yearning for material involvements. These results are possible when there is no other planet (except the Sun) transiting the 12th house from the Moon.

During its 6th house transit, Saturn effectively blocks the adverse karmic effects of earlier lives, greatly accentuates the fructification of latent faculties, and develops new talents. During this period the individual earns good income, augments his/her fixed assets, and prospers socially. Discord in material life is removed, cooperation from colleagues and relations becomes possible, and self-imposed austerities become easy to bear. The individual may occupy a new residence, move to a better environment and attain a greater seat of power. These results are obstructed by the presence of a planet in the 9th house from the Moon.

Saturn's transit through the 11th house from the Moon produces respite from difficulties of life. The individual experiences happiness of all kinds, acquires wealth, achieves professional preferment, and receives extraordinary honors. Greater opportunities to shoulder social and professional responsibilities arise during this period. It is also favorable for courtship. The transit aims at leading the individual to the universal stream of consciousness and to wider benefic influences which sustain the universe. It is the most beneficent transit of Saturn which markedly gives a new turn to the life, provided no planet transits 5th from the Moon.

Transits of Rahu

Rahu traverses the entire zodiacal cycle in about 18 years and 6 months, always moving retrograde, which gives it about 1 1/2 years in each house. It produces certain enduring results during its transit through different houses. It exposes results of one's past karmic forces and dissolves them to make the individual free to proceed speedily on one's evolutionary path. Rahu's auspicious results are experienced in the 3rd, 6th and 11th houses from the Moon, but there are no *vedhas* for Rahu.

Rahu's 3rd house transit presents before the individual situations in which he or she will have to display exemplary courage, initiative and perseverance. The mind is positively energized and special psychological qualities are aroused which become the permanent nature of the personality. During this period the individual may attain success over his/her adversaries, success in financial ventures and in setting up of profitable enterprises. He or she attains unusual inspiration from certain unknown and unexpected sources. The individual succeeds in all his ventures during this transit which imparts great self-confidence.

in the 6th house from the Moon, Rahu harnesses latent qualities of the individual and opens out new avenues for self expression. Having established a powerful link with the reservoir of natural power which the conscious mind is not ordinarily able to tap, the individual becomes exceptionally fit to achieve extraordinary results. During this period, the person attains psychological maturity and immense personal satisfaction. He or she enjoys a sense of fulfillment and experiences command over tremendous power.

Rahu in the 11th house from the Moon produces the most beneficial results. Those who are materially oriented as well as those trying to acquire religion merit gain while Rahu transits here. Rahu creates new channels of income, secures gainful social relationships and forges links with influential persons. There is also a possibility of establishing liaisons with persons of the opposite sex who might help him or her reach higher echelons of society. This period could bring windfalls to smugglers, black marketeers and persons engaged in shady deals or secret services. For those who are traversing the spiritual path, there could be sharpening of psychic perception and repugnance to material attainments. During this period, there could be an intense urge for perfection and realization of enduring values.

Transits of Jupiter

Jupiter takes 11.86 years to complete its journey around the zodiac which gives it about a year in each sign. It produces beneficial effects in the 2nd, 5th, 7th, 9th and 11th houses from the Moon. Basically, the jovian impulse is protective; during its transit through any house it fructifies the related impact of the house even if it is not directly connected with the house in the natal chart. Jupiter imparts auspicious, ethical and purifying effects. It spreads its beneficence in order to accelerate results relating to the house which for some reason have been withheld or delayed.

During its transit of the 2nd house, Jupiter helps the person relax and enjoy the natural conveniences of life. He or she acquires more money, receives social recognition and popularity, adversaries vanish, and the company of pleasant persons is available. During this jovian influence, one may expect abundant inflow of money and wealth, greater renown and professional achievements. This period is highly propitious for speculative gains. But in order to remind the individual of spiritual responsibilities, there may occur occasional illnesses and a few sorrowful experiences. During its 2nd house transit, Jupiter arouses compassion and a charitable disposition; it makes the individual's words very inspiring. These effects are however obstructed by the presence of any planet in the 12th from the Moon.

The 5th house transit of Jupiter makes the creativity of the person align with his/her ultimate destiny. The new alignment of psycho-mental creativity in the most fruitful direction provides experiences at different levels of one's existence which give great satisfaction, joy and happiness, and a feeling of psychological fulfillment. Apart from receiving increased income, unexpected honor and all round prosperity, the individual during the 5th house transit of Jupiter experiences marked expansion in his/her personality. Invariably for common individuals this period is associated with a childbirth; for intellectuals it is associated with recognition of their mental prowess evident from the publication of a book, scholarly presentation of papers or learned discourses at important conferences. These jovian influences are hampered only by the presence of a planet present in the 4th position from the Moon.

The 7th house transit of Jupiter is often described in very poetic terms. During this transit Jupiter releases its spiritualizing impulses and operates as the spring wind blowing over vegetation, producing new buds, flowers and foliage for the enjoyment of individuals and taking them towards the Supreme Power. In this position Jupiter produces the most pleasant experiences of life; almost everything the person could aspire to may be attained. The individual enjoys pleasures of the bed, pleasant company, accrual of abundant wealth, good meals, flowers, conveyances; the power of speech and the intelligence of the person are extensively recognized. The effects are obstructed by the presence of a planet in the 3rd house from the Moon.

The auspicious effects of a 9th house transit of Jupiter are proverbial. Whether the individual is attracted towards material conveniences or is inspired by spiritual ideas, Jupiter provides sustenance and energy for their fulfillment. During this period, the person succeeds in enjoying all prosperity; he or she also receives Divine Grace. Under this situation the auspicious tendencies inculcated during past lives, called *purva janma samskaras*, are energized and the individual behaves in a gracious manner. He or she receives very favorable responses from others. He or she is showered with honor and wealth; auspicious celebrations take place in the family; there could be an addition to the family, festive celebrations, and happy anniversaries; the social status of the individual is also raised. Performance of religious rituals, successful completion of purificatory practices and undertakings of pilgrimages to holy shrines or visits to inspiring places or persons are expected during this period. The individual is recognized for the maturity of his/her thoughts and helpful counseling. The presence of a planet in the 10th house from the Moon produces *vedha* for these transit effects.

Jupiter bestows much happiness when it transits the 11th house from the Moon. In harmony with its natural beneficence, during this period Jupiter enables the individual to receive material gifts, increased income, improvement in official/public status, cooperative association with friends and siblings, gains in speculative ventures, and much enhanced respectability in social circles. Even in the personal life, there is much happiness and contentment; the married life becomes very joyous, family life is very harmonious, and there are pleasant and profitable travels. The feeling of all round happiness characterizes this period. Birth of a child, acquisition of a new status, and receipt of honor from the state are natural results of the jovian transit through the 11th house from the Moon. The *vedha* for this transit arises from the presence of a planet in the 8th house from the Moon.

Transits of Mars

Mars takes a little less than two months to traverse a sign as its sidereal period is only 687 days. This planet is full of vitality. It is always eager to express itself and to produce results particularly on the physical plane. Whatever martian impact is felt on the emotional and mental well being of an individual is often indirect from its effects on his or her physical conditions. The primary effect of Mars is externalization of latent faculties which it does in every situation. Under this impact the seeds break their hard crust, sprouts extend into foliage, and plants begin to bear fruit. Mars is energy on the move; it delights in exposing difficulties, grappling with them, and overcoming all impediments obstructing its onward march. During martian transits through various signs, these features of the planet are accentuated, keeping in view the special nature of the sign traversed.

Mars has a natural affinity with the 3rd house, the house of courage, prowess and valor. Placed 3rd from the Ascendant or Moon, its natural disposition towards leadership, physical activity, the spirit of exploration, and self-reliance is expressed. Under this placement Mars leads to investigative studies, personal initiative, courage to face difficulties and heightened nervous tension. It imparts valor to the individual with enormous amounts of challenging and enterprising strength, enabling him or her to successfully complete any task howsoever difficult it might be. Whether the individual receives money, clothes, real estate, property, or honor during this period or not, is not as important as the courage and strength Mars gives to overcome adversaries and difficulties. Any planet in the 12th house from the Moon will greatly reduce these transit effects.

Mars in the 6th house arouses the capacity to dive deeply within one's psyche or in difficult physical situations to retrieve and activate hidden forces. The 6th house in the natal chart is very mysterious, containing within it the past karmic forces which have not yet been worked out. While traversing the 6th house from the Moon, Mars acquires special force to severely counteract those impediments which otherwise could have been difficult for the individual to surmount. Such a situation however assumes that there would be plenty of strife and problems in life during this period, though the end result of the martian impulse would be in the favor of the individual. Although towards the conclusion of the period there would be withdrawal of adversaries and success for the individual, one can expect that this period would witness eruption of infectious diseases such as boils or pox, as well as inconveniences and difficulties in business enterprises, litigation over property matters and other such disputes. The internal changes produced by this transit would prepare the spiritually oriented for their severe austerities and inner unfoldment. Such individuals may get valuable opportunities to come in contact with great seers and saints. They may become psychologically attuned to receive messages from the subtler realms of nature. But in the case of any other planet traversing the 9th house from the Moon, there would be obstruction to this martian transit.

In its 11th house transit, Mars acquires strength to produce much material affluence and to bestow valuable gifts to the individual. From this position the planet sufficiently energizes the sociability of the person, making him/her a socially popular and his/her speeches agreeable, relationships friendly, courteous and warm. The person becomes centrifugal or outward-turned in attitude, and people begin to like him. There is financial gain, freedom from sickness, addition to landed property, and expansion of one's social circle. Achieving success in one's ventures and acquiring much wealth and prosperity, the individual begins to feel very happy. Gain in respectability, promotion in career and enhancement in one's status are important features of this transit. The good influence of the individual increases unexpectedly and suddenly in many directions. There is also revival of old interests in life and recovery of lost property. But the transit of another planet in the 5th position from the Moon nullifies the good effects of this transit.

Transits of the Sun

The Sun covers the entire zodiacal belt in 365.25 days which gives it a month for traversing each sign. Its auspicious transits from the Moon are through the 3rd, 6th, 10th and 11th houses.

The Sun irradiates the sign it occupies and thereby vivifies the characteristics represented by the sign. The glow of the Sun is so radiant that any impediment obstructing its path is destroyed. As most of the houses in a natal chart are unable to absorb the solar effulgence fruitfully, there are only a few in which the solar transit is considered auspicious. As it is a deep-acting planet, its impact even during a month's transit is substantial.

The solar intensity, like that of Mars, is at times disturbing, but Mars expresses its impact externally whereas the Sun's impact diffuses the inner sparkle of the individual all through his or her personality. It is evident through changes in the aura of the individual or through the majestic gait and noble demeanor.

In the 3rd house from the natal Moon, the Sun leads to improvement in health, removal of obstacles and favors from superiors. During this transit, the individual acquires a new position in life, there is advent of money, experience of happiness and freedom from the feeling of inferiority. The frequency of solar transits in one's life makes them more supportive of long-term results rather than producing mere transient results of their own. Under the solar transit of the 3rd house, if some decisions concerning service matters, litigation, or disputes have been delayed and are overdue, they are decided in favor of the individual. The most significant result of the transit is to make the individual very confident, self-reliant and full of optimism. These results occur when there is no planet transiting the 9th house from the Moon.

Like Mars, the Sun is also powerful in the 6th house from the Moon. This transit activates the spirit of adventure, specially in the realm of new ideas, exploration in the secrets of nature, courageous ventures in arduous undertaking and dauntless courage for assuming herculean responsibilities if others have been reluctant to carry them out. Solar radiance in the 6th from the Moon dispels sorrow, pessimism and any feeling of lassitude. Victory of enemies, successful termination of litigation, and removal of restrictive conditions are the usual features of the transit. The precise nature of the transit results would depend upon the specific task at hand but in all cases this solar transit would provide the necessary motive force for the accomplishment of one's goal; the

impact of the transit is more in the availability of necessary motive force and energy rather than in the content of the task at hand. The 6th house solar transit releases enormous energy for the use of the individual. But the presence of a planet in the 12th house from the Moon nullifies the intensity of the solar transit effect.

During the 10th house transit, the Sun produces sufficient strength and understanding for the discharge of one's terrestrial responsibilities. During this period of the year, every year, the inner man will be reminding and inspiring the personality of its ultimate destiny. If the life of the individual is not in tune with his or her mission in life, there could then be a sense of mortification during this period, urging the individual to reorient his or her pursuit of ultimate objectives. For those whose life mission and profession are well synchronized, this period usually heralds every success, royal favor, divine direction, and generosity to one's friends and relations. There could be increased sense of pride and greater efficiency in work. The individual can realistically expect agility in action, sharpness in intellect, leadership in profession, and successful completion of difficult undertakings. The period is marked by honor, enthusiasm, pride and recognition of merit, accrual of wealth, and other professional rewards. *Vedha* for this transit arises from the presence of a transiting planet (except Saturn) in the 4th house from the natal Moon.

A new status, increased income, freedom from illness and disease, and a sense of involvement in one's undertakings of importance are some of the results of solar transits through the 11th house. During this period the individual secures recognition from the highest authority. The individual fears from none, he or she works efficiently, interacts with others correctly, and pays proper respect to others. The people in general speak well of him or her. For those who are preparing themselves for higher life, they may during this period come in contact with their mentor and guide; they are likely to receive much downpour of beneficent impulses from higher sources which could lead them to rapid progress towards their self-unfoldment. This is a very significant solar transit because it leads to accomplishment of one's goals in life, completion of arduous responsibilities, attainment of new positions and much honor. This is a period of all round self fulfillment. The difficulties in the fructification of these results occur only when *vedha* is present due to the presence of a planet other than Saturn in the 5th position from the Moon.

Some General Considerations

Short-cut transit predictions are no substitute for detailed examination of a horoscope. However, they may help the astrologer clarify the present situation for a client who needs advice quickly before a detailed analysis is completed. It is, however, important to keep in mind that these results are possible only within the parameter of planetary relationships indicated by the *dasa/bhukti* of a planet. The basic character of the chart and the status of the inner growth of the individual are important for final predictions. *Vedhas* operate unless they in turn are nullified by certain counteracting planets known as *veepareetha vedha*.

Keeping such considerations in mind, the astrologer can reasonably feel certain that during the 7 1/2 years of Saturn's *Sade Sati* when it transits the 1st, 2nd and 12th houses from the natal Moon, there are bound to be unnecessary and inexplicable mental worries, delays in achieving results, physical and psychological restrictions. There may, however, be some travels and even the celebration of marriage, yet unhappiness with one's spouse may arise. Saturn's transit over the Ascendant, midheaven, or the natal Sun may result in anguish or personal humiliation.

Jupiter's transit through the 5th house either in relation to the Moon or Ascendant would produce favorable conditions with regard to one's offspring, leading to either birth, courtship, or their marriage. This period could bring laurels due to one's creativity, publication of books or articles, or formulation of original theories. Jupiter's transits through the 5th and 7th houses provide immense satisfaction to the individual, especially with regard to material attainments.

Bepin Behari is an internationally renowned astrologer whose articles have appeared in English, Spanish and Dutch journals.

His recent publications include Myths and Symbols of Vedic Astrology, Fundamentals of Vedic Astrology, and Esoteric Principles of Vedic Astrology. His Hindi study of the Phalita Jyotisha Mein Graha Phala is highly popular among Hindi speaking students. He has been awarded the prestigious Meyer Prize of Switzerland for his original research on astrological occultism.

Bepin Behari will be a featured speaker at ACVA's 5th International Symposium on Vedic Astrology to be held in San Diego October 2-7, 1997.